



Instructor: Date:

Learner: Regional Branch:

Program: Center:

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Let's Start!

Still crazy after all these years!



Learning Outcome

Exchange information about people's interests and backgrounds using a wider range of language.

Ask your partner:

- Have you ever seen a friend you had become out of touch with after many years? What was the occasion?
- Do you believe in love at first sight? Why or why not?

Can Do Statements

- I can talk about socializing.
- I can talk about life experiences.
- I can talk about things I did or things I was doing.

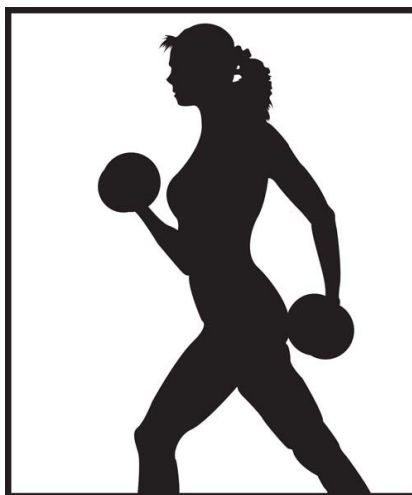




Let's Explore!

Matt tells Peter about his surprise encounter at the **water cooler***

* In North America, the "water cooler" is where you have casual conversations in an office or a workspace.



Instructions: Read the text aloud.

- Peter:** Tell me more about what happened to you at the gym. What did you say to Cathy when you saw her?
- Matt:** I really wasn't expecting to bump into her! We had broken up before I moved to Cambridge, and I hadn't heard from her until last week!
- Peter:** It must be weird to meet an old flame after all these years! I thought you guys had moved on ...
- Matt:** It was a pleasant surprise, actually. The funny thing is that she had moved to Cambridge a few weeks before I did!
- Peter:** Wait, I know where this is going. She's also a regular at your gym, right?
- Matt:** Yeah! She's a total gym rat! When I saw her, she was walking around with a 50-pound dumbbell.
- Peter:** Was she into weightlifting when you guys were going out together?
- Matt:** Not at all. I don't remember her being particularly sporty. I wouldn't mess with her now, though!
- Peter:** Yeah, she sounds tough! It looks like you guys were meant to be together!
- Matt:** I wasn't planning on it! I was filling up my water bottle when she caught my eye. I thought I had forgotten about her until last week!
- Peter:** Well, it sounds like you have rekindled your relationship. Speaking of which, what time is she supposed to come in?
- Matt:** She should be here soon. She just messaged me. She was getting ready to leave when her parents called her out of the blue.





Let's Practice!

Matt is telling his friend about his past experiences with his ex-girlfriend.

Instructions: Read the sentences aloud. Check your pronunciation with your instructor.

1. What did you say to Cathy when you saw her?
2. It looks like you guys were meant to be together!
3. I thought about her for a long time.
4. We hadn't seen each other for years!
5. She had moved to Cambridge a few weeks before I did.



Let's Practice!

Matt talks about Cathy. What does he say?

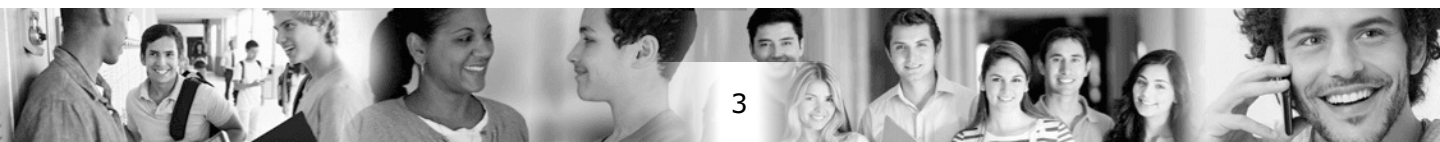
Instructions: Proofread the sentences. Underline the incorrect words. Write the sentences again correctly. Use capital letters where necessary. Read the sentences aloud. Check the pronunciation with your instructor.

1. When I was seeing her, she walked around with a 50-pound dumbbell.

2. I filled up my water bottle when she was watching my eye.

3. She got ready to leave when her parents saw her out of the blue.

4. We met in the afternoon but she thought we should meet in the evening.





Extension Activity

Role-play a dialogue with your partner about a funny coincidence.

Instructions: Complete the following steps. Fill in the Self-Assessment.

- With a partner, write a dialogue (12-14 lines) about meeting a friend by chance after a long time.
- Role-play a surprising situation and describe the coincidence by which you met your friend.
- Think of all the things you can talk about to catch up.
- Remember to use the appropriate tenses in the past.
- Share your dialogue with other partners.

Self-Assessment

Yes

No

I talk about social activities.

☐ ☐

I discuss past experiences.

☐ ☐

I talk about what I was doing when something else happened.

☐ ☐


Target Words

- old flame** (expression): used to refer to an ex-girlfriend
e.g. It must be weird to meet an old flame after all these years!
- to rekindle** (verb): to revive or renew something
e.g. Well, it sounds like you have rekindled your relationship.
- to move on** (verb): to concentrate one's attention or emotions on other matters in recovering from a setback or difficulty
e.g. I thought you guys had moved on ...
- weightlifting** (noun): the lifting, pushing, or pulling of weights
e.g. Was she into weightlifting when you guys were going out together?
- gym rat** (expression): used to refer to someone who spends a lot of time at the gym
e.g. Yeah! She's a total gym rat!
- to mess with** (verb): to use or handle something carelessly
e.g. I wouldn't mess with her now, though!





Learning Points

Past Perfect tense

You use the Past Perfect tense to identify and talk about an 'earlier past'.

When you are talking about a past event, you can refer to something that happened at an earlier time to that past event by using the Past Perfect tense.

The structure of the Past Perfect is:

Subject + had + past participle

*We **had broken up** before I moved to Cambridge.*

Which event happened first? We broke up.

Which event happened later? I moved to Cambridge.

*You use the Past Perfect tense (not Simple Past) when you want to talk about how long something had continued **up to a past moment**.*

Example:

I hadn't heard from her until last week!

Examples:

- *The funny thing is that she had moved to Cambridge a few weeks before I did!*
- *I thought I had forgotten about her until last week!*





Learning Points

Simple Past vs Past Continuous

You use the Past Continuous to describe events in the past that were interrupted by another, shorter action.

You use the Simple Past for past events or actions that have a clear beginning and end in the past.

The form of the Past Continuous is:

Subject + was/were + verb-ing

You can use the Past Continuous to:

- to describe the background in a story written in the past tense

For example:

*When I saw her, **she was walking** around with a 50-pound dumbbell.*

- to describe an action that was interrupted by another event or action

For example:

***She was getting** ready to leave when her parents called her out of the blue.*

Examples:

- *I really wasn't expecting to bump into her!*
- *Was she into weightlifting when you guys were going out together?*

